



SPARK COMPANIES

Spark Circuit

The Field Guide

Your first weeks, start to finish —
the reference you keep at your desk.

ONE STANDARD

What's inside

- 01 Machine Ready — Computer set-up. Password, MFA, Wi-Fi, OneDrive, Chrome, settings.
- 02 Plugged In — The stack, Teams, your signature, LinkedIn, bookmarks, Bookings.
- 03 Welcome to Spark — The story, the family of companies, the values, the language.
- 04 The Craft — Staffing, sourcing, prescreens, the law — plus the live ATS Sandbox: run a full placement yourself.
- 05 One Standard — HR & compliance. Respect, confidentiality, pay, security, EEO — signed.
- + The Eight Values, Key Contacts, and the Kanban — quick reference at the back

This guide is the read-only companion to Spark Circuit, the interactive onboarding experience in Spark HQ. The drills, sandbox, attestations, and your certificate live in the app — this is the reference you can print, mark up, and keep at your desk.

Machine Ready

Computer set-up. Password, MFA, Wi-Fi, OneDrive, Chrome, settings.

01

Change Your Password

First move on day one: take control of your account.

- 01 Go to microsoft.com and click Sign in
- 02 Sign in with your Spark email
- 03 Click your profile photo in the right corner
- 04 Click View account
- 05 Click Change password, follow the prompt, and click Submit

While you're in Microsoft 365: click your initials (top right) and create a strong password you'll actually remember — this is how you'll log in to Outlook and your computer going forward. Then press Ctrl+Alt+Delete, go to Sign-in options, click the key, and enter the new password there too.

CHECK IT OFF

- Password changed in Microsoft 365
- Windows sign-in updated to the new password

Microsoft Authenticator

Multi-factor authentication is a MUST DO. It's what keeps your account yours.

- 01 Install Microsoft Authenticator on your mobile device
- 02 Open the Authenticator app
- 03 Select Add account (the plus symbol at the top, next to Search)
- 04 Choose Work account
- 05 Select Sign in and sign in with your company email and password — or scan the QR code if the company provided one
- 06 Once your account appears, use one-time codes to sign in to Microsoft 365

CHECK IT OFF

- Authenticator installed on my phone
- Work account added and generating codes

Wi-Fi + Phone Set-Up

If you're in the Troy office, connect your cell phone and laptop to Wi-Fi:

Network	SparkWireless
Password	Spark2015

Then download the Microsoft Outlook app on your cell phone so email travels with you.

CHECK IT OFF

- Laptop connected to SparkWireless
- Phone connected to SparkWireless
- Outlook app installed on my phone

OneDrive

Find the cloud icon at the bottom of your screen. If it says up to date, you're good. If there's a no-smoking sign, it is not uploading — sign in with your email and password (the cloud should be blue).

Always save your work under OneDrive on your computer. If your laptop ever dies, your files don't.

CHECK IT OFF

- OneDrive signed in, blue, and up to date
- I save everything to OneDrive

Google Chrome, Not Edge

Use Google Chrome. Certain plug-ins we rely on only work in Chrome.

SET DEFAULT BROWSER IN WINDOWS

- 01 Go to Settings
- 02 Search "default apps" in the search bar
- 03 Click Default apps
- 04 Scroll to Default browser
- 05 Switch to Google Chrome

SET DEFAULT BROWSER IN TEAMS

- 01 Click the three dots in the right corner of Teams
- 02 Click Settings
- 03 Click Files and Links
- 04 Under "Always open Word, PowerPoint, and Excel files in" choose Default browser
- 05 Under "Links open preference" choose Default browser

Do BOTH of these.

CHECK IT OFF

- Chrome is my Windows default browser
- Chrome is my Teams default browser

Dial In Your Settings

Power & sleep	Under "additional power settings" find "Choose what closing the lid does." Default is shut down on lid close — change it to what works for you.
Bluetooth	Settings, then Devices, then Add Device
Pin apps to taskbar	Open the app, right-click, Pin to taskbar. Suggestions: Chrome, Teams, Outlook, Files, Excel, Word, Snip
Multiple monitors	Settings, System, Display — Identify 1/2/3, then Apply. Brightness lives on this tab too.
Shut down	You don't have to shut down daily, but do it every other day so updates run. Always shut down before it goes in a backpack — sleep mode gets hot. Never leave your laptop in your car.
Notifications & actions	Pop-ups appear in the right-hand corner. Go through them all and select or unselect to your preference. Sounds — you don't need to hear them all day.
Date & time	If wrong: Settings, Time & Language, pick the correct time zone.

CHECK IT OFF

- Lid-close behavior set
- My daily apps are pinned
- Notifications tuned
- Date and time verified

FIELD NOTES — STAGE 01

Machine quirks worth remembering — monitors, printer, settings you changed:

Plugged In

The stack, Teams, your signature, LinkedIn, bookmarks, Bookings.

02

The Spark Tech Stack

DAILY UPKEEP

- Microsoft 365 — Teams, Word, Excel, Copilot, Outlook
- Spark Boards — onboarding + project tracker
- SharePoint — important files
- Salesforce / Asymbi — our ATS and CRM

EMAIL

- Outlook
- Barracuda — email phishing protection and reporting

JOB BOARDS (IF REQUIRED)

- LinkedIn + LinkedIn Recruiter
- Indeed
- ZipRecruiter
- ZoomInfo

ONBOARDING & HR

- Spark HQ — training, guides, and materials
- Greenshades — request PTO, pay, floating holidays

DOWNLOAD ON YOUR MOBILE DEVICE

- Outlook
- Teams
- LinkedIn
- Microsoft Authenticator
- GreenEmployee
- Xero Me (if needed)

CHECK IT OFF

- Mobile apps downloaded

Teams Set-Up

SET YOUR SPARK BACKDROP

- 01 Save the company backdrop (from the Spark All Team Photo doc) to your files
- 02 Open the Teams app
- 03 Go to Calendar
- 04 Click Meet now
- 05 Hit the camera button in the left corner
- 06 Click Effects and avatars
- 07 Click More video effects (lower right)
- 08 Click Add new
- 09 Select the Spark backdrop from your files and click Open

AUTO-START TEAMS

- 01 Open Teams
- 02 Three dots on the right-hand side
- 03 Settings, General, Systems
- 04 Check Auto-start Teams

Audio issues or AirPods not connecting? Three dots, Settings, Device, Audio Settings, click Speaker.

REMOVE AUTO TEAMS MEETINGS FROM OUTLOOK INVITES

- 01 Open Outlook
- 02 Settings
- 03 Calendar
- 04 Events and invitations
- 05 Uncheck "Add online meeting"

CHANNELS & CHATS — WHERE THE COMPANY TALKS

Channel: Spark Portfolio	Click "Channels" in the upper left of Teams. This is for important weekly announcements — the onboarding tracker updated daily, the weekly charge report, and announcements from the executives and TMX team.
Chat: Spark Portfolio — ALL TEAM	Click "Chats" in the upper left. Company-wide quick hits: a new post going live, a team member's birthday, reminders.

CHECK IT OFF

- Spark backdrop set
- Teams auto-starts
- I know the Spark Portfolio channel and ALL TEAM chat



Outlook Signature

Build your signature right here — fill in your details, copy, and paste it into Outlook. The full manual steps are below if you prefer the template route.

MANUAL ROUTE: TEMPLATE FROM THE SPARK ALL TEAM PHOTO DOC

- 01 Open Outlook
- 02 Click Settings (upper right corner)
- 03 Click Account
- 04 Click Signature
- 05 Click Add New Signature and title it
- 06 Paste the template into the blank white area
- 07 Type your information into the signature
- 08 Right-click the LinkedIn embedded photo, click Edit Link
- 09 Delete the current LinkedIn URL
- 10 On LinkedIn: click your picture (upper right), View profile, copy the URL from the search bar
- 11 Paste your LinkedIn URL into the Edit Link line and press Done
- 12 Press Save
- 13 Select your signature title in BOTH dropdowns under "Select default signature" — for new messages AND for replies and forwards

CHECK IT OFF

- Signature set in Outlook
- My LinkedIn URL is linked
- Default for new messages and replies

Teams vs. Email

We've all been there — wondering whether to send an email or a Teams message. Here's the quick guide.

USE TEAMS WHEN

- You need a quick response or real-time collaboration
- It's a short question or update
- You're working a project with ongoing back-and-forth
- You want to share a file or link quickly

Think of it like tapping someone on the shoulder.

USE EMAIL WHEN

- You're sharing detailed or formal information
- You need to loop in external contacts
- You want to document a decision or summary
- The message is not time-sensitive

Think of it like sending a letter with a paper trail.

NEVER MISS A TEAMS MESSAGE

- 01 Open Microsoft Teams
- 02 Click your profile picture (top right), then Settings
- 03 Go to Notifications
- 04 Under "Missed activity emails" choose how often to be notified — As soon as possible works well
- 05 Customize alerts for @mentions, replies, and chat messages

CHECK IT OFF

- Missed activity emails turned on
- I know when to use Teams vs. email

LinkedIn Set-Up

Your LinkedIn gets branded to Spark — use the header photo from the Spark All Team Photo doc.

- 01 Log into LinkedIn
- 02 Click your profile photo, then View profile
- 03 Press the pencil/edit button on the same line as your name
- 04 Type your title and company into the Current Position section, press Save
- 05 Click the pencil/edit button in the top right of the header photo
- 06 Choose the Spark header photo and click Save
- 07 Scroll to Experience and click the pencil/edit button
- 08 Press the plus in the upper right, Add position, and enter everything including start date to present
- 09 Press Save

CHECK IT OFF

- Title and company set
- Spark header photo up
- Experience added, start date to present

Google Account + Bookmarks

CREATE A GOOGLE ACCOUNT

- 01 Go to Google and click Sign in
- 02 Click Create new account, then "for my personal use"
- 03 Type your information and use your existing Spark email
- 04 Enter the code sent to your email
- 05 Create a password
- 06 Enter your phone number for a verification code

07 Click Create account

HOW TO SAVE A BOOKMARK

- 01 Open the tab you want to save
- 02 Click the star in the URL bar (top right)
- 03 Click Bookmarks bar
- 04 Click Done

WHAT YOU NEED BOOKMARKED

Greenshades	Pay stubs, time-off requests, floating holidays — anything HR-related. GreenEmployee is the mobile app.
LinkedIn	Your Spark-branded profile.
Michigan Talent Bank	The Michigan unemployment site. Everyone who applies for unemployment must create a profile here, so it's a real sourcing resource. On a high-level executive search it may not be the best tool, but you should have it.
Microsoft 365	The web version of your email. If something happens to your computer, your email lives here. Bookmark it.
Spark HQ	Houses all of our training guides and materials — including this one.
SharePoint	Important company files. Log in once and bookmark it.
PI Board	In SharePoint, search "PI Board" and bookmark the result.
Spark Boards	Onboarding and project tracking. Log in and bookmark.
Salesforce	spark-companies.my.salesforce.com — the ATS/CRM you'll live in.
Barracuda	Email gateway defense — where quarantined mail lands.

CHECK IT OFF

- Google account created with my Spark email
- All bookmarks saved to the bookmarks bar

Bookings

SET UP BOOKINGS

- 01 Go to the Office 365 portal at office.com
- 02 Select All Apps, then click Bookings (search for it if you don't see it)
- 03 If prompted, click Get It Now
- 04 Enter the name of your business and select the type
- 05 Click Continue to create your booking calendar

BUSINESS INFORMATION

Name	Your name
Logo	Add the company logo
Business type	Other
Business hours	Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM

CUSTOMIZE YOUR BOOKING PAGE

- 01 Go to the Booking Page tab
- 02 Set time increments, minimum lead time, and maximum lead time
- 03 Enable or disable customer email notifications
- 04 Click Save and publish

CHECK IT OFF

- Booking calendar created
- Business info saved with logo
- Booking page published

FIELD NOTES — STAGE 02

Where things live — channels, bookmarks, tools (never write passwords):



Welcome to Spark

The story, the family of companies, the values, the language.

03

The Spark Story

Founded in 2013 by Aaron Opalewski, Spark Talent Acquisition is a Michigan-headquartered recruiting and staffing organization that connects great talent with great employers. Finding a new position is stressful, and identifying top talent is hard — so we start by listening to and understanding each client's individual needs. We believe in face-to-face interaction and a solid understanding of a client's business before placement.

We pride ourselves on team development and a culture of accountability. Our goal is never to connect candidates on skill set alone — culture, shared values, and intangibles matter just as much. And our commitment to 24-7 availability sets us apart: staffing is a full-time responsibility, and we accommodate any shift need that arises.

OUR PURPOSE

Spark's purpose is to help PEOPLE grow. Our mission: create 100,000 annual opportunities across the nation. Money is the product of outstanding service — it follows, it does not lead. We operate in the recruiting industry, but we are in the people development business. Empowerment, freedom, and unlimited professional and personal growth.

CHECK IT OFF

- I can say our purpose out loud: help people grow — 100,000 annual opportunities

Family of Companies

HOW OUR COMPANIES ARE STRUCTURED

- 1 management company — Spark Companies (sparkcompanies.com)
- 1 content creation company — Bolt Creative Strategies (boltcreativestrategies.com)
- 5 staffing companies — Spark Talent (sparktalentinc.com), Spark Packaging (sparkpackaginginc.com), John Joseph Partners (johnjosephpartners.com), Ignite Executive Search (ignitesearch.com), Flex Workforce Solutions (flexworkforceco.com)

MAIN POINTS OF CONTACT

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ENTITY CONTACTS

- Spark Packaging — Alex Gorman
- John Joseph Partners (JJP) — Alex Gorman
- Ignite Search — Alex Gorman
- Bolt Creative Strategies — Aaron Opalewski
- Flex Workforce Solutions — Ryan Aymen

The live org chart lives in Spark HQ — who reports to whom, who to talk to about tasks, and how business units are aligned.

CHECK IT OFF

- I know who to contact for each entity
- I found the org chart in Spark HQ

Dress Code

At Spark, we value a casual work environment — wear clothing that's comfortable and practical for your job. Attire should remain appropriate and respectful to keep a professional atmosphere.

- No clothing with words, images, or symbols that could be offensive to coworkers, clients, or visitors
- Spark-logo apparel is encouraged — team spirit, unified image
- Sports teams, universities, and fashion-brand logos are generally fine
- Business casual is expected when meeting external clients or guests
- Lounge pants, sweatpants, and basketball shorts are not workplace-appropriate
- Shorts are allowed on Fridays in the summer

- Hats and beanies: Fridays only — unless they carry the company logo, in which case any day works

CHECK IT OFF

- Dress code read and understood

The Eight Values

These are the eight things we actually mean. Tap each card to flip it, then pick the one that will be hardest for YOU to live — that answer is worth keeping.

LEADING BY EXAMPLE ISN'T JUST A WAY, IT'S THE ONLY WAY

Regardless of job title, every person in our organization leads by example. Cross-functional support is critical, and the best way to stay close to your business is rolling up the sleeves and diving in. You can't expect others to do something you wouldn't be willing to do.

DO THE RIGHT THING

The root of our organization stems from making the right decisions with the utmost integrity and respect for the people around us — even when no one is looking. You can never go wrong doing the right thing.

CONQUERING ADVERSITY IS THE RECIPE TO SUCCESS

A service-based industry demands aggressive patience. Overcoming adversity is part of life, and persevering through objections defines your character. As Muhammad Ali said: "I hated every minute of training, but I said, 'Don't quit. Suffer now and live the rest of your life as a champion.'"

BE HUMBLE. CRAVE IMPROVEMENT

If you aren't learning, you aren't leading. Self-development should never have a cap. Every day is a chance to be a student and a teacher. Find value in people regardless of background or skill set — open your mind and you'll unlock potential you never imagined.

WE ARE PEOPLE DRIVEN AND SERVICE FOCUSED

Our product may be a service, but our passion lies in the people we interact with daily. It's a non-negotiable expectation that team members go the extra mile to deliver the best result for the people we work with.

DOMINATE THE DAY, DON'T LET THE DAY DOMINATE YOU

Tenacity, old-school grit, and the vision to succeed can't lead you in the wrong direction. Each day gives you a choice to be great. We strive for nothing short of greatness — the best preparation for tomorrow is doing the best you can today.

FIND A WAY TO DELIVER VALUE

Impacting the outcome starts with an inquisitive approach and a desire to leverage every resource necessary. Figuring it out is the nucleus of what we're all about. Our team members hunt for solutions to serve our clients.

MINDSET IS THE FOUNDATION OF EXCELLENCE

Why have a glass half empty when it can be half full? Every day presents challenges, but those challenges are ultimately opportunities. A positive attitude is the core of achievement and the framework for a successful day.

Meetings, Igniters, PI Board

MANDATORY MEETINGS

Bi-weekly company meetings	Tuesdays at 4:00 PM — applies to everyone. Company updates on Igniters, important news, and achievements.
Sales trainings	Recruiters, ARMs, AREs, Directors
Recruiting trainings	Recruiters, ARMs, AREs, Directors
PI Board meetings	Monday and Friday at 8:45 AM — Recruiters, ARMs, AREs, Directors

THE VOCABULARY

Igniters	Each division's goals for the year — the GP goal.
PI Board	How recruiters track annual GP, KPIs, and numbers. Get in: log into SharePoint and search "PI Board."

CHECK IT OFF

- Company meetings and PI Board on my calendar
- I can open the PI Board

Words Matter LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

Language shapes culture. Small shifts in vocabulary have a big impact on team unity, client relationships, and mindset.

Team members, not employees	We're all part of a high-performance team working toward a common goal — internally and with clients.
Positive phrasing	Instead of "No problem," use "My pleasure" or "Absolutely." Service-focused tone, zero negative connotations.
Gratitude over "Happy Friday"	Every day is a gift. Gratitude for life and health keeps us aligned with excellence — not counting down to the weekend.
Value language in sales FIELD NOTES — STAGE 03	Avoid "fee," "cost," and "bill" — they imply loss. Use "invoice," "investment," and "search." "Investment in the project" frames the client's benefit.

Now prove it. Eight rounds — replace the corporate phrase with the Spark phrase.

People I met this week and what they own:

The Craft

Staffing, sourcing, prescreens, the law — plus the live ATS Sandbox: run a full placement yourself.

04

What Is Staffing?

Staffing is the process of strategically identifying, recruiting, and placing the right talent into roles that support an organization's goals. It means understanding workforce requirements, sourcing qualified candidates, and ensuring a strong match on skills, experience, and culture. Done well, it doesn't just fill vacancies — it builds a resilient workforce.

THE FIVE COMPONENTS

1. Workforce planning	Assess current and future staffing needs; identify skill gaps and forecast hiring.
2. Recruitment	Attract candidates through postings, referrals, and sourcing; promote the employer brand.
3. Selection	Screen resumes, conduct interviews, evaluate — choose the best fit on skills, experience, and culture.
4. Onboarding	Introduce new hires to the culture, tools, and processes; ensure a smooth transition.
5. Retention & development	Keep people engaged; offer training, career growth, and performance feedback.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Ensures business continuity and productivity
- Builds a strong company culture
- Reduces turnover costs and improves satisfaction
- Meets strategic goals with the right talent in place

Quick tips: use data to guide hiring decisions, weigh skills AND cultural fit, keep communication clear and timely, invest in development.

CHECK IT OFF

- I can explain staffing and its five components

The Recruiting Lifecycle LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

Every placement moves through the same Kanban in Salesforce. Know it cold — it's how the whole company reads your pipeline.

Req qualifications	Qualify the req with the hiring manager or account rep, establish expectations, enter it in the system, manage it in real time.
Sourcing talent	Create a sourcing strategy, set daily phone screen goals, build niche networks.
Screening candidates	Qualify with references, screen for skills and culture fit, finalize lockdown, generate leads.
Selection	Represent the candidate, prep them to win the interview, debrief afterward and update the req.
Servicing client & contractor	First-day and first-week calls, consistent performance feedback, rehire quality contractors whenever possible.

Now the drill: tap the Kanban stages in order.

Job Reqs

QUALIFY THE REQ WITH THE ACCOUNT MANAGER

- Clarify expectations — skills, experience, timeline
- Ask questions — why is it open? Backfill, new role, or contract extension?
- Understand priorities — must-haves vs. nice-to-haves

Use intake meetings to align on goals and avoid miscommunication later.

LEARN & RESEARCH THE ROLE AND THE CLIENT

- Study the job description — responsibilities, skills, qualifications
- Research the client — industry, culture, values (LinkedIn, Glassdoor, their website)
- Know the team — who does the candidate report to? What's the dynamic?

MANAGE REQUISITIONS (ACCOUNT MANAGERS)

- Track progress — enter reqs into the ATS and PI Board
- Prioritize high-impact or urgent roles first
- Keep stakeholders updated on progress, challenges, and market feedback

HANDS-ON: FIND A REQ IN SALESFORCE

- 01 Log into Salesforce
- 02 Hit the waffle button, then Recruiting (make sure "Jobs" is on your tab line — use the pencil editor to add it)
- 03 Search for the company: PLC Programmer, Pari Robotics, Rochester Hills
- 04 Click Related, scroll to Jobs, click the job — the job details ARE the req
- 05 Change the logo to the appropriate internal company

HANDS-ON: POST THE JOB

- 01 Go to the job's Details tab and scroll to External Job Description
- 02 Paste the JD into the External Job Description text box (use the job post template)
- 03 Check "post externally" on the details of the job

CHECK IT OFF

- Found the Pari Robotics req in Salesforce
- Posted a job externally using the template

Sourcing

Sourcing is the art and science of identifying candidates who match the req. Master it and you'll always have a pipeline.

STRATEGY

- Proactive beats reactive — don't wait for applicants, go find them
- Targeted outreach — relevant experience and cultural fit
- Pipeline building — maintain a pool of qualified candidates for future roles

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- Tenure — stability and growth in previous roles
- Red flags — frequent job changes, vague titles, unexplained gaps
- Qualifications — match skills, certifications, and education to the req

BOOLEAN SEARCH

Combine keywords into a search string. Example for a Controls Engineer with PLC, HMI, SCADA experience: ("controls engineer" OR "automation engineer" OR "electrical engineer") AND ("PLC" OR "HMI" OR "SCADA")

TOOLS

- Job boards — LinkedIn, Indeed, ZipRecruiter, ZoomInfo
- The ATS — source from existing candidates first
- Social media — Facebook, Instagram, and beyond

DAILY GOALS & ORGANIZATION

- Prepare for tomorrow — build your call sheet the night before
- Set phone screen goals per your assigned KPIs
- Block time daily for sourcing and cold calling — consistency builds momentum

HANDS-ON: SOURCE IN THE ATS

- 01 No job to work? Go to Search and use filters to source through the system
- 02 Have an opening? Go to the job (use Pari Robotics), use Applicants & Match
- 03 Work Search and Match to find qualified candidates
- 04 Source 2 candidates for the position

CHECK IT OFF

- Sourced 2 candidates for the Pari Robotics req
- I can write a boolean string for my niche

Call Sheets & Outreach

BUILD A CALL SHEET IN SALESFORCE

- 01 Go to a job
- 02 Source candidates through the system or add new ones
- 03 On a candidate profile, use the Task button (left-hand side) to schedule a call for the future
- 04 Your call sheet lives in your ATS Kanban

CALLS

- Be prepared with a brief pitch and key questions
- Respect time zones and working hours — adjust your schedule to the candidate's
- Always introduce yourself clearly
- Ask if it's a good time to talk
- Be polite, and fluctuate your voice

VOICEMAILS

- Keep it short and professional
- Include your name, company, role, and callback info

MESSAGES & TEXTS

- Personalize — mention the role, the company, and why they'd be a good fit
- Keep texts concise and professional
- Always try calling before texting, unless it's a quick update

EMAILS

- Clear subject line
- Include job details, next steps, and contact info

HANDS-ON: LOG IT ALL IN SALESFORCE

- Log tasks, calls, prescreens, notes, and calendar events
- Know how to navigate to a candidate profile

CHECK IT OFF

- Call sheet built in my Kanban
- I've logged a task, a call, and a note in SF

The Prescreen LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

Prescreening determines whether a candidate meets the basic qualifications and is a real fit before anyone invests more time.

WHY PRESCREENS MATTER

- Save time by filtering out unqualified candidates early
- Build rapport and assess communication skills
- Clarify resume details and uncover red flags
- Set expectations for the role and next steps

FLOW OF THE CONVERSATION

- 01 Introduction — who you are and why you're calling
- 02 Candidate overview — let them share their background; listen
- 03 Role & company overview — explain the position and the client
- 04 Q&A — ask targeted questions, let them ask theirs
- 05 Next steps — outline exactly what happens after the call

REFERENCES

- Ask if they can provide professional references
- Note hesitation or lack of references as a potential concern
- Confirm reference types — manager, peer, client

PHONE ETIQUETTE

- Warm, clear, professional tone
- Respectful language and active listening
- Conversational, not scripted — build rapport
- Be transparent

Prescreen template lives in Asymb! go to log a call, click in the text box, press Ctrl+Period, and select Prescreen from the template list. Log a sample prescreen tagged "Training Prescreen" in Chatter for leader review.

Time for a rep. Jordan is a CNC machinist who just picked up your call.

Art of the Reference

PRE-CALL PREPARATION

- Candidate name, company name, manager info (title, contact)
- Type of employment and agency used, if any
- Total dates of employment and time under the manager's supervision
- The candidate's feedback about this manager — use it to build rapport

THE INTRO — SET THE TONE

- Introduce yourself and thank them for their time
- Explain why you're calling — considering the candidate for X role
- Use the candidate's words: "They mentioned you helped them improve their leadership and gave them exposure to PLC programming."
- Casually confirm title, team size, and their time managing the candidate

TEDW — CONVERSATION. NOT INTERROGATION

Tell me. Explain. Describe. Walk me through. Open-enders get you stronger answers than rapid-fire yes/no questions.

CORE REFERENCE QUESTIONS

Core responsibilities	"Walk me through what they handled day to day."
Quality of work	"Describe how they performed in their role."
Technical skills	Tailor to the req — electrical, mechanical, PLCs
Attitude & effort	"Tell me about their attitude and work ethic."
Team fit	"How did they collaborate across departments?"
Attendance	Ask only if relevant — engineering vs. floor matters
Reason for leaving	"Can you share your perspective on their departure?"
Additional notes	"Anything I should share with their next leader?"

TRY TO SET THE MEETING

"Based on what I know, [candidate] came through [agency]. We're a direct competitor and would love to introduce our services. Would tomorrow at 11 AM work?"

LOG IT

- 01 Fill out the reference document
- 02 Upload it into the candidate's files in Asymb1
- 03 Change the logo to the appropriate internal company

CHECK IT OFF

- I know TEDW and the core reference questions
- Reference logged in Asymb1

Submittal, Interview, Offer

SUBMITTAL — THE FORMAL PRESENTATION

- Qualify the candidate with references first — recent managers, supervisors, or peers; document feedback in the ATS
- Write the submittal from the template — copy and paste with the correct information
- Attach the resume and relevant documents
- Formatting and spelling clean and professional — the submittal reflects YOU

Hands-on: log into SF, go to the candidate profile and job, add the candidate to the job, then move them from Sourced to Submit on the Kanban.

INTERVIEW — SCHEDULE, PREP, FOLLOW UP

- Confirm availability with both parties; coordinate the logistics (virtual link, location, time zone); double-check formats
- Send the candidate a detail email: date, time, format, interviewer names and titles, company overview, prep materials
- Prep the candidate to win: presentation tips, JD talking points, research the company, prepare questions — offer a mock Q&A if needed
- After: ask the client for feedback and next steps; run a post-interview call with the candidate; update the ATS with everything

VERIFICATION

- Confirm the client wants to move forward — offer, or another interview?
- Verify candidate details: references, availability, salary expectations
- Be proactive — timely follow-up keeps momentum and shows professionalism

THE HIRING DECISION

Make the call	Be excited: "Congratulations — you got the job!" Confirm their decision and give a timeline if they need to think.
If they accept	Send offer details to TMX (onboarding team) — start date, compensation, special instructions. Push the offer through the ATS, attach documentation, align the candidate for onboarding.
If they decline	Notify the Account Manager, share why (compensation, other offers, fit), document in the ATS with notes for pipeline planning. Keep it positive — declines can still become future placements.

CHECK IT OFF

- Submitted a candidate on the Kanban
- I know the interview prep and follow-up sequence
- I know the accept and decline paths

The Sandbox: Run a Placement LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

Everything you just learned, end to end — in a working replica of the ATS with training data. No trainer needed, nothing to break. Five missions: add a candidate, attach them to the live req, log a prescreen, log a reference, and walk them across the Kanban to Placement.

The Kanban enforces the real rules: no submittal without a logged prescreen, no interview without a reference on file, no skipping stages. If you try, it tells you why — the same way your leader would.

First Day & Service

BEFORE THE FIRST DAY

- Confirm start date and time with both candidate and client
- Send a first-day prep email at least 2 business days out: start time, location or link, point of contact, dress code, materials, parking or check-in
- Day-before check-in call: confirm they're ready, answer questions, share the excitement

FIRST-DAY COORDINATION

- Notify the client the candidate is set to arrive; share any updates
- Update the ATS: mark them Started, log the check-in call

FIRST-DAY FOLLOW-UP

- Call or message after their first day — ask how it went
- Address concerns fast; share feedback with the Account Manager if needed

ONGOING COMMUNICATION

Check-ins	Weekly or bi-weekly. Experience, workload, concerns. Document in the ATS to flag issues early.
Performance feedback	Share client feedback — positive AND constructive — professionally and supportively.
Redeployment	Spot high performers nearing assignment end and proactively match them to new roles. Redeployment cuts time-to-fill and strengthens client relationships.
Hours & pay liaison	You're the point of contact for timesheet, hours, and pay issues. Communicate with the candidate and TMX, resolve fast, log every concern and resolution in the ATS.

CHECK IT OFF

- First-day prep email template ready
- My check-in cadence is set

The Law: Recruiting & Terminations LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

Federal law prohibits discrimination throughout recruiting, onboarding, and the workplace — enforced largely by the EEOC. Spark Talent is an Equal Opportunity Employer.

PROTECTED CLASSES (INCLUDING MICHIGAN'S ELLIOTT-LARSEN ADDITIONS)

- National origin
- Race
- Color
- Sex
- Age 40+
- Religion
- Genetic information
- Marital status
- Height / weight
- Arrest record
- Disability

EIGHT LAWS TO KNOW

Title VII, Civil Rights Act of 1964	No discrimination on race, color, religion, national origin, or sex — including pregnancy and sexual harassment.
Equal Pay Act of 1963	No paying different wages to men and women doing essentially the same work under similar conditions.
Civil Rights Act of 1966	No discrimination based on race or ethnic origin.
Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986	No discrimination on national origin or citizenship of persons authorized to work in the U.S.
Americans with Disabilities Act	No discrimination against persons with disabilities.
Bankruptcy Act	No discrimination against anyone who has declared bankruptcy.
Equal Employment Opportunity Act	No discrimination against minorities based on poor credit ratings.
ADEA	No discrimination against individuals age 40 or above.

TIPS TO STAY CLEAN

- Go with the natural flow of the interview and stay conversational. If an applicant mentions a protected class, don't panic — pivot and note that Spark complies with the EEOC
- Keep it professional; never ask personal questions in an interview
- Document legitimate, non-discriminatory reasoning for decisions; never note a protected class. Notes are facts, never opinions
- Pivot back to job-related questions rather than away from uncomfortable subjects

TERMINATIONS — THE PROCESS

- Get feedback from the client: the reason (performance, attendance, fit) with specific examples or documentation

- Call the candidate directly — never deliver termination details in a voicemail; if no answer, leave a message asking for a callback only
- Walk through the feedback clearly and respectfully. Facts, not feelings: "The client has decided to end the assignment due to attendance concerns."
- Never communicate through family or friends
- Don't apologize — stay neutral, transparent, and polite; respect their dignity
- Log it in the ATS: reason, client feedback, date. Notify payroll so final pay is right. Keep records secure and confidential
- Offer to help with future opportunities when appropriate

MICHIGAN SPECIFICS

- At-will employment: termination any time, for any reason — as long as it's not illegal
- Illegal reasons: discrimination (Elliott-Larsen Civil Rights Act), retaliation for whistleblowing or reporting unsafe conditions (Whistleblowers' Protection Act), breach of a written or implied contract
- Always confirm no protected status or retaliation risk before proceeding
- Never discuss termination details with other candidates or coworkers

Radar check: six scenarios. Call each one CLEAN or LINE CROSSED.

Charge + Your 30/60/90

HOW CHARGE WORKS

Charge (the bill rate) is what we invoice the client for a contractor's hour. It has to cover the contractor's pay, the burden on that pay (payroll taxes, workers' comp, insurance), and the gross profit that keeps the lights on. Charge discipline is how the PI Board numbers stay real.

The worked examples and entity-specific burden rates live in the Charge Calculation guide in Spark HQ — your leader will run it with you live. Use the calculator below to build the feel.

30, 60 & 90-DAY EVALUATIONS

There will be 30-, 60-, and 90-day evaluations with you and your leader to make sure you're on track and fully understanding the recruiting process and daily responsibilities. Pin the eval sheet in your cubicle as a reminder to stay focused and keep developing.

- When it's eval time, your leader will notify you
- You complete the self-evaluation section first
- Then you review it together with your leader
- It is YOUR job to get these done well — and to remind your leaders and peers when you need help hitting one of these goals

CHECK IT OFF

- I can walk the charge math out loud
- Eval sheet pinned at my desk
- 30-day self-evaluation date known

One Standard

HR & compliance. Respect, confidentiality, pay, security, EEO — signed.

05

Respectful Workplace

Spark maintains a workplace free of harassment, discrimination, and retaliation — full stop. This applies in the office, on client sites, on calls, in Teams, and at company events.

WHAT CROSSES THE LINE

- Unwelcome conduct based on any protected class — verbal, physical, or visual
- Sexual harassment of any kind, including unwelcome advances, comments, or messages
- Jokes, slurs, or "banter" targeting someone's identity — intent doesn't erase impact
- Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith

IF YOU SEE IT OR EXPERIENCE IT

- Report it to your team leader, any leader you trust, or Operations (Allie Spiegel / Mary Patrico)
- Reports are handled promptly, discreetly, and without retaliation
- You will never be penalized for raising a concern in good faith

Leaders have a duty to act on anything they see or hear. "I didn't want to get involved" is not a Spark answer.

Confidentiality & Data

Every day you'll handle information people trusted us with: candidate resumes, pay details, client rates, internal numbers. Treat it like it's yours — because protecting it is.

- Candidate PII (resumes, pay, references, personal details) stays in the ATS and approved systems — never in personal accounts or group chats
- Client information — rates, org charts, openings — is never shared outside the team that needs it
- All files live in OneDrive or SharePoint. Nothing company-related on personal drives or USB sticks
- Never share your credentials with anyone, including coworkers
- Lock your screen when you step away (Windows key + L)
- Termination details, investigations, and pay issues are discussed only with the people who need to know

Pay, PTO & Timekeeping

Greenshades is home base for everything pay: pay stubs, PTO requests, and floating holidays. GreenEmployee is the mobile app.

- Request PTO in Greenshades with as much notice as you can — your leader approves it there
- Review every pay stub. If something looks off, flag it immediately to Payroll (Priyanka Malani)
- If your role records time, your time records must be accurate and yours alone — never punch, log, or adjust for someone else
- Floating holidays are requested through Greenshades like PTO

Pay problems are fixed fast when they're raised fast. Never sit on a discrepancy.

Phishing & Security LIVE DRILL IN THE APP

You are the last line of defense. Barracuda filters email, MFA guards your account — but a rushed click beats both.

- Report suspicious email through Barracuda — when in doubt, report it out
- Never approve an MFA prompt you didn't trigger. Ever. Report it immediately
- Verify unusual requests (gift cards, wire changes, urgent payroll edits) by CALLING the person on a known number
- Check the actual sender address, not the display name
- Hover before you click; never enter credentials from an email link
- Laptop physical security: shut down before it goes in a bag, never leave it in your car

Radar check number two: five messages just hit your inbox. Call each one.

Equal Opportunity & I-9

Spark Talent is an Equal Opportunity Employer. Employment decisions — hiring, placement, pay, promotion, termination — are made on qualifications, performance, and business need. Never on a protected class.

- The protected classes you drilled in Stage 04 apply internally too — including Michigan's Elliott-Larsen additions: marital status, height/weight, arrest record
- Every new hire completes Form I-9 employment eligibility verification within the first three days of work
- Reasonable accommodations: if you need one, raise it with your leader or Operations — the conversation is confidential
- Concerns about discrimination follow the same reporting path as harassment: any leader you trust, or Operations

FIELD NOTES — STAGE 05

Questions for my leader:

QUICK REFERENCE

Keep these cold

THE KANBAN — EVERY PLACEMENT, IN ORDER

Sourcing › Match › Submittal › Interview › Onboarding › Placement

No submittal without a logged prescreen. No interview without a reference on file. No skipping stages.

THE RANK LADDER

DAY ONE › MACHINE READY › PLUGGED IN › SPARK FLUENT › CRAFT CERTIFIED ›
CLEARED · ONE STANDARD

YOUR TRAINING REQ

SPK-1042 · PLC Programmer — Pari Robotics · Rochester Hills, MI · \$28–32/hr

MY KEY DATES

Start date

30-day evaluation

60-day evaluation

90-day evaluation

First placement

Generated from Spark Circuit content — if the app and this PDF ever disagree, the app is current. ONE STANDARD.

